Moving downstream, Goswami, along with seven men, managed to cross the considerably large stream by jamming logs between rocks to construct a makeshift bridge.

In the hut, the Chinese were most relaxed, for, until then, there had been no aggressive intent shown by any of the Indian troops. A lone sentry was on duty a few yards from the hut. It was beginning to get dark and Goswami and two men closed in on the unsuspecting soldier, getting close enough to hit him on his head with the butt of a rifle. Having grabbed the dazed soldier, they started to drag the captured sentry towards the crossing point.

As they approached the water, there were two loud explosions. The Chinese had realized the sentry was missing, so Goswami's rearguard threw two grenades into the hut before making a dash for the logs. The entire area erupted in gunfire, and soon Very lights were arcing skywards, illuminating the river. Halfway across the Mago Chu with his inert prisoner, Goswami had no option but to kill him and save his own party. The Chinese soldier's rifle was, however, sent to Brigade HQ the next day.

Throughout this period, other than the one visit to Se-la on 7 November, Kaul's attention had been entirely on the Lohit Frontier Division. Having declared that the troops should focus on stocking up for the winter rather than worry too much with defences, the corps commander had mentally switched off from the Kameng Sector. With GOC 4 Division also content to sit back in Dirang Dzong, commander 62 Infantry Brigade, Hoshiar Singh, was more or less left alone to counter the developing situation.

Only someone who has been on a Himalayan high-altitude pass can imagine the conditions at Se-la, especially at night. The defensive deployment meant that at any given time there were close to a hundred men out in the raw blistering cold, where the wind chill factor further aggravated the existing arctic conditions. Unfortunately, most of the officers were ensconced in bunkers with bukharis (kerosene heaters) burning to keep them warm instead of being out with the men, where they should have been practising counter-attacks and other battle drills. The reason for this perhaps was Hoshiar's unfamiliarity with the troops he was commanding and also the fact that many officers, including the commanding officer of 2 Sikh LI, Lieutenant Colonel A. R. Irani, were still scrambling to get to their units. Irani had only returned to the unit on 9 November.